

CAREERUP AFRICA

Comprehensive Business Overview

1. Executive Summary

CareerUp Africa is a cohort-based competence validation and hiring infrastructure designed for early-career professionals across Africa.

It is not:

- A mentorship platform
- A training platform
- A job board
- An internship marketplace

It is:

A structured system where early-career professionals prove their competence through real-world shadowing and are evaluated by industry professionals, creating a trusted hiring layer beyond CVs.

CareerUp Africa exists to solve the gap between learning and employability.

2. The Core Problem

For Talents

- They complete courses.
- They earn certificates.

- They lack real-world validation.
- They struggle to get hired due to lack of experience.
- They compete in CV-driven environments where credibility is self-declared.

For Industry Professionals / Startups

- They need talent.
- They want to reduce hiring risk.
- They do not want to rely solely on CVs.
- They want to test talent before hiring.

For Hiring Managers / Recruiters

- CVs are unreliable.
- LinkedIn is self-declared.
- Portfolios can be curated.
- Interviews do not always reflect competence.

There is currently no structured, trusted competence verification layer in the African early-career market.

CareerUp Africa fills that gap.

3. What CareerUp Africa Is

CareerUp Africa is a competence validation infrastructure built around structured evaluation, shadowing, and badge-based verification.

It is a system where:

- Talents prove competence.

- Industry professionals evaluate competence.
- Hiring managers recruit verified competence.

It creates an ecosystem where competence is observed, recorded, and validated by third parties.

4. Stakeholders

1. Talents

Early-career professionals who:

- Have completed courses
- Want to prove competence
- Want structured evaluation
- Want hiring visibility
- Want real-world experience

They enter through a gated qualification system before joining the platform.

2. Industry Professionals / Startups

- Founders
- Operators
- Senior professionals
- Growing companies

They:

- Accept talents for 6-week shadowing cycles
- Provide structured feedback
- Evaluate performance
- Optionally hire after validation

They get risk-free evaluation access to talent before committing to hiring.

3. Hiring Managers / Recruiters

They:

- Access the verified talent directory
- View structured evaluations
- Filter by badge levels
- Hire based on competence history

They gain access to competence-backed profiles instead of self-claimed resumes.

5. Cohort-Based Admission Model

CareerUp Africa operates on a quantity-controlled cohort system.

Each cohort admits a fixed number of talents.

Example:

- Cohort 1 → 100 talents
- Once 100 qualified talents are admitted → Cohort 1 closes
- Website automatically updates to “Join Cohort 2”

Cohorts are based on quantity, not dates.

This creates:

- Controlled growth
- Quality management
- Scarcity positioning
- Structured evaluation cycles
- Operational balance
- Prestige signaling

Each cohort becomes a contained validation batch.

6. Platform Model

Step 1: Pre-Qualification (Before Account Creation)

Before joining a cohort, talents submit:

- Name
- Email
- LinkedIn
- Course taken
- Industry interest

They complete structured industry-specific competency questions.

If they pass:

- They are admitted into the active cohort (if spots remain).

If the cohort is full:

- They are placed into the next cohort queue.

If they fail:

- They receive feedback via email.
- They may retry after improvement.

This ensures quality control before platform access.

Step 2: Account Creation and Profile Setup

Once admitted:

Talents:

- Create full profile
- Select industry focus
- Define values and preferences
- Indicate shadowing interests

Profiles remain incomplete until shadowing begins.

Step 3: Matching

CareerUp matches talents with:

- Industry Professionals
- Startups

Matching is based on:

- Industry
 - Competence focus
 - Professional expectations
 - Availability
-

Step 4: Six-Week Shadowing Cycle

Each talent participates in a structured six-week shadowing cycle.

During this period:

- They observe
- Assist
- Execute assigned responsibilities
- Demonstrate reliability and initiative

At the end of six weeks:

Industry Professional provides structured evaluation across:

- Execution
- Reliability
- Initiative
- Communication
- Professional conduct

This evaluation becomes part of the talent's permanent competence record.

7. Badge Structure

CareerUp Africa uses simple, powerful badge signaling.

1. Field Ready Badge

Awarded when a talent passes the pre-qualification assessment.

This signals:

- Baseline competence verified.
 - Entry into the platform approved.
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2. Top Executor Badge

Awarded when a talent successfully completes a 6-week shadowing cycle with strong evaluation.

This signals:

- Demonstrated real-world execution.
 - Positive structured feedback from industry professional.
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3. High Performer Badge

Awarded when a talent is successfully hired after shadowing.

This signals:

- Proven competence.
- Market validation.
- Conversion from evaluation to employment.

These badges form the visible competence identity of each talent.

8. Hiring Model

Hiring occurs in two ways:

1. The Industry Professional hires after the six-week shadowing cycle.
2. External Hiring Managers recruit from the verified talent directory.

CareerUp earns:

A percentage (example: 20%) of the talent's first month salary upon successful placement.

This is the primary revenue model.

9. Revenue Model

Primary Revenue:

- Placement fee (percentage of first month salary)

Future Revenue Options:

- Recruiter subscription for directory access
 - Premium visibility options for talents
 - Corporate subscription for priority matching
 - Cohort sponsorship partnerships
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10. Strategic Positioning

CareerUp Africa positions itself as:

A competence validation layer.

Not a training platform.
Not a CV marketplace.
Not a freelance site.

It becomes:

An infrastructure for competence verification.

Over time, it aims to become the trusted hiring standard for African early-career professionals.

11. Long-Term Vision

Phase 1

Shadowing-based competence validation with cohort structure.

Phase 2

Structured verified talent directory accessible to recruiters.

Phase 3

Recognized African competence hiring standard.

Phase 4

Industry-wide competence index infrastructure.

CareerUp Africa aims to become:

A trusted competence verification layer across industries in Africa.

12. Core Identity Statement

CareerUp Africa is a cohort-based competence validation and hiring infrastructure that transforms early-career professionals into verified, hire-ready talent through structured shadowing, third-party evaluation, and badge-based verification.

1. TALENT JOURNEY FLOW

DISCOVERY



Pre-Qualification



Cohort Admission



Profile Creation



Matching



6-Week Shadowing



Evaluation



Badges Earned



Hiring (Optional)

Expanded Visual Process

1 Discovery

- Sees “Join Cohort 1 (74/100 spots filled)”
- Clicks Apply

2 Pre-Qualification (Gatekeeping Layer)

Submits:

- Name
- Email
- LinkedIn
- Course taken
- Industry interest

Answers competency questions.

If pass →

- Receives Field Ready Badge
- Admitted into cohort (if space available)

If fail →

- Receives feedback email
 - Can retry later
-

3 Cohort Admission

- Dashboard unlocked
 - Profile setup required
-

4 Matching

Platform matches based on:

- Industry
 - Availability
 - Preference alignment
-

5 6-Week Shadowing

Talent:

- Observes

- Assists
 - Executes
 - Demonstrates reliability
-

6 Evaluation

Industry professional rates:

- Execution
 - Initiative
 - Communication
 - Professional conduct
 - Reliability
-

7 Badge Layer

- Field Ready Badge
 - Top Executor Badge (after successful cycle)
 - High Performer Badge (if hired)
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8 Hiring Outcomes

- Hired by shadow host
OR
 - Visible in verified talent directory
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2. INDUSTRY PROFESSIONAL / STARTUP FLOW

Sign Up



State Talent Needs



Receive Match



6-Week Shadowing



Evaluate Talent



Optional Hire

Expanded Visual Process

1 Registration

- Submit profile
 - Industry
 - Type of support needed
-

2 Talent Request

State:

- Role focus
 - Expected involvement
 - Weekly time commitment
-

3 Match Assigned

Platform sends:

- Talent profile
 - Pre-qualification status
 - Cohort info
-

4 6-Week Shadowing

Professional:

- Delegates structured responsibilities
 - Observes execution
 - Monitors reliability
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5 Structured Evaluation

Submits evaluation:

- Ratings
- Comments
- Final recommendation

This becomes part of talent's permanent record.

6 Optional Hire

If hired:

- CareerUp earns first-month percentage

If not:

- Talent still retains evaluation record
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3. HIRING MANAGER / RECRUITER FLOW

Sign Up



Access Verified Directory



Filter by Badge



View Evaluation History



Contact Talent



Hire

Expanded Visual Process

1 Account Creation

- Verified recruiter profile
-

2 Directory Access

Can filter by:

- Industry
 - Cohort
 - Badge level
 - Performance rating
-

3 Profile Deep Dive

Sees:

- Field Ready status
- Shadowing history
- Evaluation breakdown
- Badge progression

No CV dependence.

No self-claimed competence.

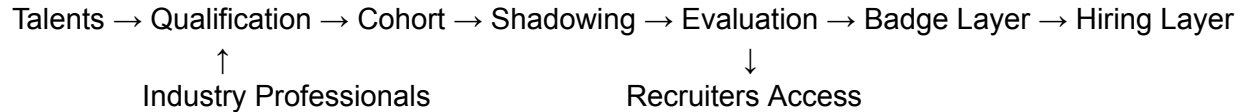
4 Outreach

- Direct contact via platform
 - Interview scheduling
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5 Hire

Placement fee triggered.

SYSTEM OVERVIEW (FULL ECOSYSTEM FLOW)



HOW THIS LOOKS AS A WEBSITE VISUAL

You can present this in 3 clean horizontal sections:

SECTION 1: FOR TALENTS

Headline:

Prove Your Competence

3 Icons:

- Pass Assessment
 - Shadow Industry
 - Earn Verified Badges
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SECTION 2: FOR INDUSTRY PROFESSIONALS

Headline:

Evaluate Before You Hire

3 Icons:

- Get Matched

- Test Talent
- Hire With Confidence

SECTION 3: FOR RECRUITERS

Headline:

Hire Verified Competence

3 Icons:

- Browse Verified Profiles
- Review Structured Evaluations
- Recruit With Reduced Risk